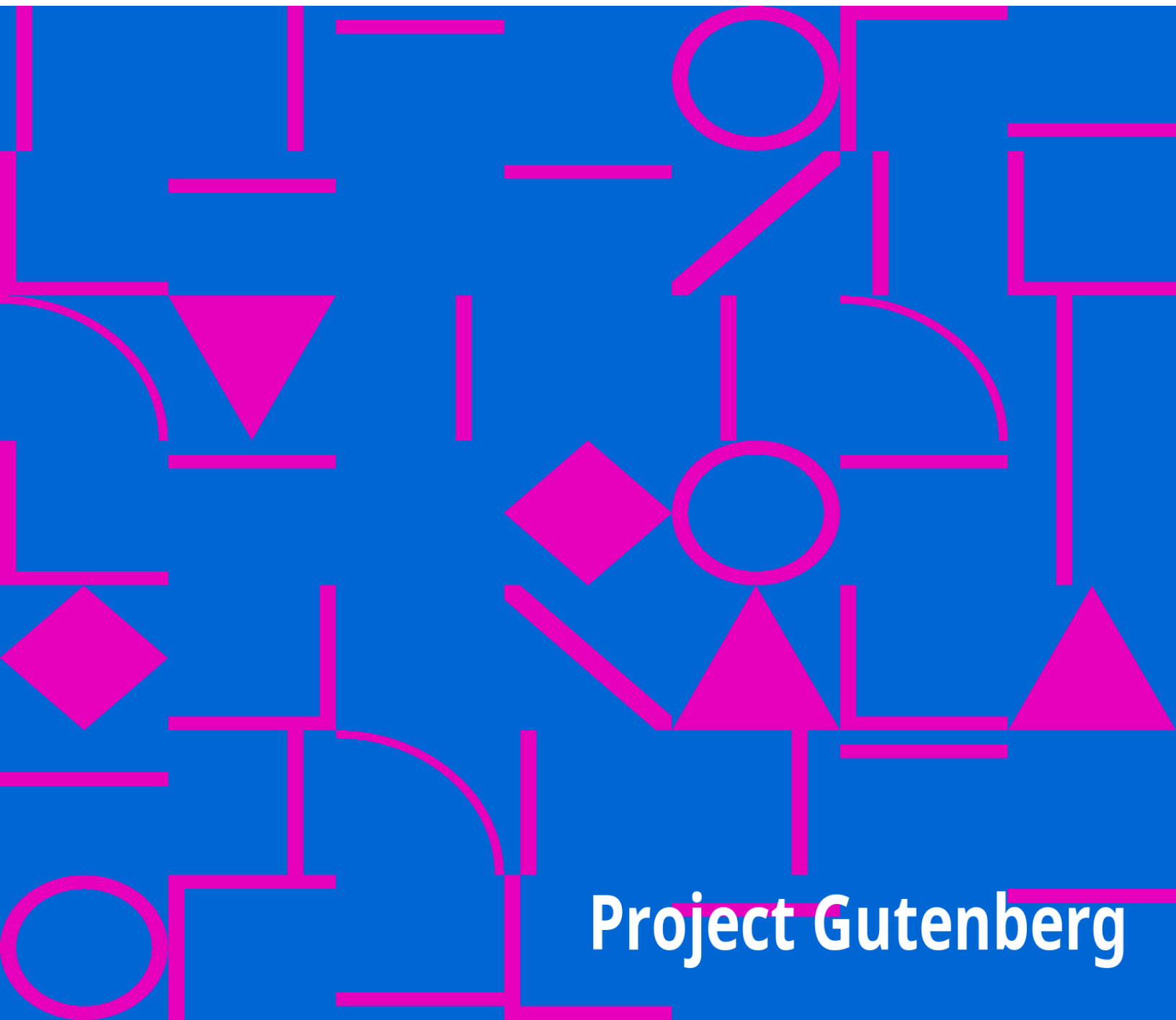


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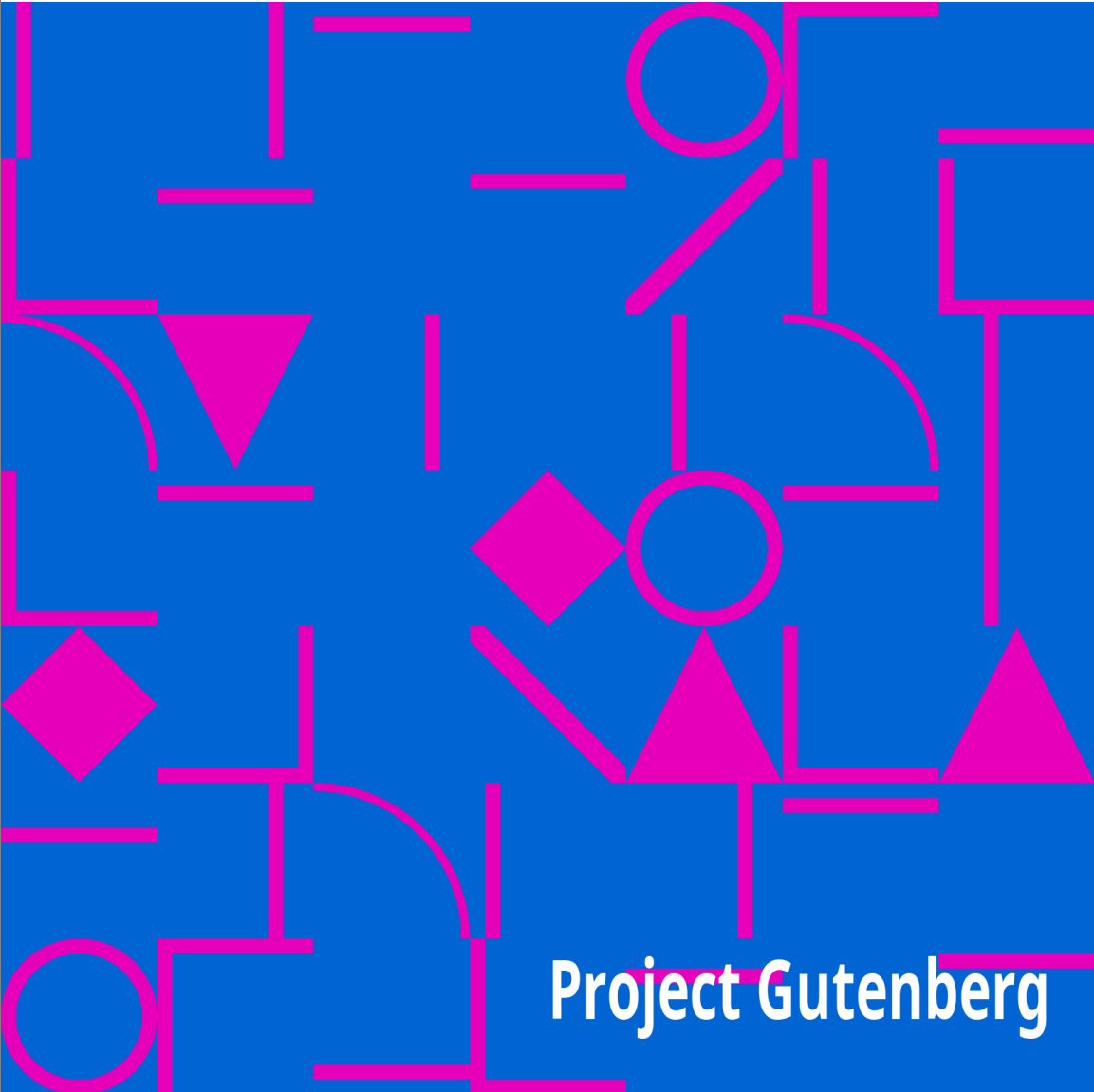
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE WORLD
ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB): MALACHI ***

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**Book 39 Malachi 001:001 An
oracle: the word of Yahweh to
Israel by Malachi. 001:002 "I have
loved you," says Yahweh. Yet you
say, "How have you loved us?"
"Wasn't Esau Jacob's brother?"
says Yahweh, "Yet I loved Jacob;
001:003 but Esau I hated, and
made his mountains a desolation,
and gave his heritage to the jackals
of the wilderness." 001:004
Whereas Edom says, "We are**

beaten down, but we will return and build the waste places;" thus says Yahweh of Armies, "They shall build, but I will throw down; and men will call them 'The Wicked Land,' even the people against whom Yahweh shows wrath forever." 001:005 Your eyes will see, and you will say, "Yahweh is great— even beyond the border of Israel!" 001:006 "A son honors his father, and a servant his master. If I am a father, then where is my honor? And if I am a master, where is the respect due me? Says Yahweh of Armies to you, priests, who despise my name. You say, 'How have we despised your name?'

**001:007 You offer polluted bread
on my altar. You say, 'How have we
polluted you?' In that you say,
'Yahweh's table contemptible.'**

**001:008 When you offer the blind
for sacrifice, isn't that evil? And
when you offer the lame and sick,
isn't that evil? Present it now to
your governor! Will he be pleased
with you? Or will he accept your
person?" says Yahweh of Armies.**

**001:009 "Now, please entreat the
favor of God, that he may be
gracious to us. With this, will he
accept any of you?" says Yahweh of
Armies. 001:010 "Oh that there
were one among you who would
shut the doors, that you might not**

kindle fire on my altar in vain! I have no pleasure in you," says Yahweh of Armies, "neither will I accept an offering at your hand. 001:011 For from the rising of the sun even to the going down of the same, my name is great among the nations, and in every place incense will be offered to my name, and a pure offering: for my name is great among the nations," says Yahweh of Armies. 001:012 "But you profane it, in that you say, 'Yahweh's table is polluted, and its fruit, even its food, is contemptible.' 001:013 You say also, 'Behold, what a weariness it is!' and you have sniffed at it," says

Yahweh of Armies; "and you have brought that which was taken by violence, the lame, and the sick; thus you bring the offering. Should I accept this at your hand?" says Yahweh. 001:014 "But the deceiver is cursed, who has in his flock a male, and vows, and sacrifices to the Lord a blemished thing; for I am a great King," says Yahweh of Armies, "and my name is awesome among the nations." 002:001 "Now, you priests, this commandment is for you. 002:002 If you will not listen, and if you will not lay it to heart, to give glory to my name," says Yahweh of Armies, "then will I send the curse on you, and I will

**curse your blessings. Indeed, I have
cursed them already, because you
do not lay it to heart. 002:003**

**Behold, I will rebuke your seed,
and will spread dung on your faces,
even the dung of your feasts; and
you will be taken away with it.**

**002:004 You will know that I have
sent this commandment to you,
that my covenant may be with
Levi," says Yahweh of Armies.**

**002:005 "My covenant was with
him of life and peace; and I gave
them to him who he might be
reverent toward me; and he was
reverent toward me, and stood in
awe of my name. 002:006 The law
of truth was in his mouth, and**

unrighteousness was not found in his lips. He walked with me in peace and uprightness, and turned many away from iniquity. 002:007 For the priest's lips should keep knowledge, and they should seek the law at his mouth; for he is the messenger of Yahweh of Armies. 002:008 But you have turned aside out of the way. You have caused many to stumble in the law. You have corrupted the covenant of Levi," says Yahweh of Armies. 002:009 "Therefore I have also made you contemptible and base before all the people, according to the way you have not kept my ways, but have had respect for

persons in the law. 002:010 Don't we all have one father? Hasn't one God created us? Why do we deal treacherously every man against his brother, profaning the covenant of our fathers? 002:011 Judah has dealt treacherously, and an abomination is committed in Israel and in Jerusalem; for Judah has profaned the holiness of Yahweh which he loves, and has married the daughter of a foreign god.

002:012 Yahweh will cut off, to the man who does this, him who wakes and him who answers, out of the tents of Jacob, and him who offers an offering to Yahweh of Armies.

002:013 This again you do: you

cover the altar of Yahweh with tears, with weeping, and with sighing, because he doesn't regard the offering any more, neither receives it with good will at your hand. 002:014 Yet you say, 'Why?' Because Yahweh has been witness between you and the wife of your youth, against whom you have dealt treacherously, though she is your companion, and the wife of your covenant. 002:015 Did he not make one, although he had the residue of the Spirit? Why one? He sought a godly seed. Therefore take heed to your spirit, and let none deal treacherously against the wife of his youth. 002:016 For I hate

divorce," says Yahweh, the God of Israel, "and him who covers his garment with violence!" says Yahweh of Armies. "Therefore take heed to your spirit, that you don't deal treacherously. 002:017 You have wearied Yahweh with your words. Yet you say, 'How have we wearied him?' In that you say, 'Everyone who does evil is good in the sight of Yahweh, and he delights in them;' or 'Where is the God of justice?' 003:001 "Behold, I send my messenger, and he will prepare the way before me; and the Lord, whom you seek, will suddenly come to his temple; and the messenger of the covenant,

whom you desire, behold, he comes!" says Yahweh of Armies. 003:002 "But who can endure the day of his coming? And who will stand when he appears? For he is like a refiner's fire, and like launderer's soap; 003:003 and he will sit as a refiner and purifier of silver, and he will purify the sons of Levi, and refine them as gold and silver; and they shall offer to Yahweh offerings in righteousness. 003:004 Then the offering of Judah and Jerusalem will be pleasant to Yahweh, as in the days of old, and as in ancient years. 003:005 I will come near to you to judgment; and I will be a swift witness against the

**sorcerers, and against the
adulterers, and against the
perjurers, and against those who
oppress the hireling in his wages,
the widow, and the fatherless, and
who deprive the foreigner of
justice, and don't fear me," says
Yahweh of Armies. 003:006 "For I,
Yahweh, don't change; therefore
you, sons of Jacob, are not
consumed. 003:007 From the days
of your fathers you have turned
aside from my ordinances, and
have not kept them. Return to me,
and I will return to you," says
Yahweh of Armies. "But you say,
'How shall we return?' 003:008
Will a man rob God? Yet you rob**

me! But you say, 'How have we robbed you?' In tithes and offerings. 003:009 You are cursed with the curse; for you rob me, even this whole nation. 003:010 Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse, that there may be food in my house, and test me now in this," says Yahweh of Armies, "if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there shall not be room enough for. 003:011 I will rebuke the devourer for your sakes, and he shall not destroy the fruits of your ground; neither shall your vine cast its fruit before its time in the field," says Yahweh of Armies.

003:012 "All nations shall call you blessed, for you will be a delightful land," says Yahweh of Armies.

003:013 "Your words have been stout against me," says Yahweh.

"Yet you say, 'What have we spoken against you?' 003:014 You have said, 'It is vain to serve God;' and 'What profit is it that we have kept his charge, and that we have walked mournfully before Yahweh of Armies? 003:015 Now we call the proud happy; yes, those who work wickedness are built up; yes, they tempt God, and escape.' 003:016 Then those who feared Yahweh spoke one with another; and Yahweh listened, and heard, and a

book of memory was written before him, for those who feared Yahweh, and who honored his name.

003:017 They shall be mine," says Yahweh of Armies, "my own possession in the day that I make, and I will spare them, as a man spares his own son who serves him.

003:018 Then you shall return and discern between the righteous and the wicked, between him who serves God and him who doesn't serve him. 004:001 "For, behold, the day comes, it burns as a furnace; and all the proud, and all who work wickedness, will be stubble; and the day that comes will burn them up," says Yahweh of

**Armies, "that it shall leave them
neither root nor branch. 004:002
But to you who fear my name shall
the sun of righteousness arise with
healing in its wings. You will go out,
and leap like calves of the stall.
004:003 You shall tread down the
wicked; for they will be ashes
under the soles of your feet in the
day that I make," says Yahweh of
Armies. 004:004 "Remember the
law of Moses my servant, which I
commanded to him in Horeb for all
Israel, even statutes and
ordinances. 004:005 Behold, I will
send you Elijah the prophet before
the great and terrible day of
Yahweh comes. 004:006 He will**

turn the hearts of the fathers to the children, and the hearts of the children to their fathers, lest I come and strike the earth with a curse."

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